MarginMix

Agency Audit Questions

Complete question bank · Blank questionnaire reference

This document lists every question in the audit intake, including conditional questions for different service types, commercial models and engagement stages. Some questions appear in the online form only when earlier answers make them relevant.

67 questions across 9 sections

Your details

Who is completing this intake?

Q1. First, what's your name?

Short response · Required

Q2. What's your email address?

Email address · Required

We'll email a PDF of your responses to this address after you submit, with a copy to Sid.

Q3. What's your agency's name?

Short response · Required

Engagement

The work, contract and decision you are evaluating.

Q4. What should we call this engagement?

Short response · Required · Unknown allowed

Use a client/project reference. An anonymous reference is fine.

Q5. What services are you delivering?

Select all that apply · Required

Choose all that apply. Your answers tailor the questions ahead.

- [ ] Marketing, creative or media
- [ ] Consulting or advisory
- [ ] IT-enabled or operational services
- [ ] Software development
- [ ] Implementation / professional services
- [ ] Managed services / ongoing support
- [ ] Other

Q6. Tell us about your other services.

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Q7. How is this engagement priced?

Select all that apply · Required

Select every component. Multiple selections create a hybrid intake.

- [ ] Commission
- [ ] Fixed fee / fixed price
- [ ] Retainer
- [ ] Time & Materials
- [ ] Outcome / success-based
- [ ] Subscription / SaaS
- [ ] Other

Q8. Describe the other pricing arrangement.

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Explain how fees are earned, the delivery obligations, and any minimums or caps.

Q9. What decision are you evaluating?

Select one · Required

[ ] Accepting a new engagement
[ ] Reviewing an active engagement
[ ] Renewing a contract
[ ] Expanding or changing scope
[ ] Recovering an engagement under pressure
[ ] Approving a strategic exception

Q10. What period should we assess?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

For an open-ended engagement, use the next contract review as the expected end.

Table fields

- Engagement start (date)
- Expected end / next review (date)
- Assessment period start (date)
- Assessment period end (date)

Q11. How will the work be delivered?

Select all that apply · Required · Unknown allowed

[ ] Onsite
[ ] Remote
[ ] Offshore / nearshore
[ ] Multiple locations
[ ] External partners

Q12. Where will delivery happen, and how will teams coordinate?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List locations, currencies, coverage hours, time-zone overlap and handoff requirements. For a single team, say so.

Financial baseline

Define retained revenue and the margin you want to protect.

Q13. Which currency should we use?

Short response · Required · Unknown allowed

Use this currency for all amounts. List other currencies and FX assumptions in the next question.

Q14. Do other currencies affect this engagement?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List currencies, exchange-rate assumptions and contractual FX protection. Enter “None” if not applicable.

Q15. Which margin are you assessing?

Select one · Required · Unknown allowed

The audit must use one consistent cost definition.

[ ] Delivery / gross margin — less direct delivery costs
[ ] Contribution margin — less specified attributable costs
[ ] Operating margin — includes allocated overhead
[ ] Unsure — help us define this

Q16. Which costs are included in your margin definition?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Identify included and excluded costs. Avoid adding employment overhead again if it is already in loaded role costs.

Q17. What is your target margin?

Number · Required · Unknown allowed

Enter a percentage, not a decimal fraction. Choose Unknown if no target has been defined.

Q18. What revenue do you expect to retain?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Separate base fees, variable fees and other retained revenue. Exclude client pass-through spend.

Table fields

- Revenue component
- Amount (number)
- Period / earning condition
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q19. What reduces the revenue you retain?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Include refunds, clawbacks and partner shares. If none, add “None” with amount 0.

Table fields

- Discount / credit / rebate / revenue share
- Amount (number)
- When it applies
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q20. Are any billings pass-through amounts?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Keep client spend separate from agency revenue. If none, add “None” and 0 for amounts.

Table fields

- Media / production / tax / other
- Gross amount (number)
- Retained markup / commission (number)
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q21. What are the payment and cancellation terms?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Include invoice timing, payment days, deposits, termination notice, amounts recoverable on cancellation, and purchases you must fund upfront.

Scope & delivery

Describe the work, team, capacity and delivery costs.

Q22. What is included in the agreed scope?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Deliverable / service
- Quantity / frequency
- Acceptance criteria
- Included revisions
- Key exclusions

Q23. What staffing is needed?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Include account management, meetings, review, QA and senior oversight. Use role-level costs, not employee salary records.

Table fields

- Role / grade
- Location
- Planned hours (number)
- Loaded hourly cost (number)
- Internal / contractor
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q24. Can the team deliver within the planned window?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

State whether available hours are before other commitments. Identify single-person or supplier dependencies.

Table fields

- Role / skill
- Available hours (number)
- Competing committed hours (number)
- Overtime / hiring / dependency

Q25. What other delivery costs will arise?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Do not repeat contractors already included in staffing. If none, add “None” with amount 0.

Table fields

- Vendor / travel / tool / hosting / other
- Amount (number)
- Period / cost driver
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q26. Are setup, transition, warranty or exit activities included?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List the work, hours/costs, and whether the client pays separately. Enter “None” if not applicable.

Q27. What overhead is allocated to this engagement?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Only include costs required by your chosen margin definition. Do not double-count loaded staffing costs.

Table fields

- Overhead item
- Amount (number)
- Allocation basis
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Progress to date

Compare actual performance with what remains.

Q28. What has happened so far?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Include recognized revenue, worked hours, incurred costs and accepted deliverables. Keep invoicing and unpaid balances separate.

Table fields

- Revenue / hours by role / costs / accepted work
- Actual value / quantity
- Currency / hours / units
- Actuals through (date)

Q29. What work and revenue remain?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Remaining deliverable / role / cost / revenue
- Amount / hours
- Unit
- Expected date (date)
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q30. How does performance compare with the original plan?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Explain effort/cost overruns, fee changes, delays, non-billable work and the reasons for material differences.

Q31. What scope changes have occurred?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

If none, add “None”, zero amounts and “Not applicable” for approval/recovery.

Table fields

- Scope change
- Extra hours (number)
- Extra cost (number)
- Client approval status
- Additional fee (number)
- Expected recovery

Commercial model

Questions tailored to how this engagement earns revenue.

Q32. What value is commissionable?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Describe the spend/sales base and assessment period. Give expected and credible downside volumes, with the evidence supporting them.

Q33. How is commission earned and retained?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Commission base / tier
- Net retained rate % (number)
- Minimum fee / threshold
- Cap
- Rebates / shares / clawbacks

Q34. What costs remain if commissionable volume falls?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Include fixed account-team costs, cancellations and obligations to fund client spend before reimbursement.

Q35. What fixed fees apply to each deliverable or milestone?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Deliverable / milestone
- Fee (number)
- Effort assumptions
- Acceptance / payment terms
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q36. What protects the fixed-fee scope?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

State included revisions, client dependencies, change-order pricing/approval/recovery, contingency, warranty and unpaid post-delivery work.

Q37. What does the retainer include?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Give the fee per period, minimum term, included hours/outputs/service levels, reserved capacity and expected demand by service category.

Q38. How are overages, capacity and renewal handled?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Explain rollover, unused allowances, overage rates, minimum staffing, onboarding, notice periods, cancellation and fee escalation.

Q39. What are the T&M rates and hours?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Role / location
- Sell rate / hour (number)
- Loaded cost / hour (number)
- Expected worked hours (number)
- Expected billed hours (number)
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q40. What limits T&M billing or rate recovery?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Include client approval, non-billable time, utilization, realization, caps, discounts, guaranteed hours, rejected timesheets/write-offs, bench and rate-versus-cost escalation dates.

Q41. What makes the payment contingent?

Select one · Required · Unknown allowed

Acceptance milestones and success fees expose the agency to different risks.

[ ] A measured business outcome / success
[ ] Acceptance of completed milestones
[ ] Both, under separate conditions

Q42. What is the exact outcome-payment formula?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Include guaranteed fees, payout thresholds/caps, baseline, attribution, verification, measurement window, payment lag, dispute terms and clawbacks.

Q43. What supports your outcome scenarios?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Do not invent probabilities. Distinguish agency-controlled outcomes from external dependencies.

Table fields

- Low / expected / high outcome
- KPI / milestone result
- Fee earned (number)
- Supporting evidence / assumptions

Q44. What is spent even if no variable fee is earned?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Quantify unavoidable delivery costs, client obligations and external factors affecting success.

Q45. How is managed-service demand charged and forecast?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Specify the charging unit (ticket, transaction, user, capacity etc.), fee, demand by complexity/category/season, handling effort and escalation rate.

Q46. What coverage and SLA obligations apply?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

State coverage hours, minimum staffing, on-call effort, service targets, credits/penalty caps, infrastructure/licensing/support costs, transition and exit work.

Q47. What makes implementation or software delivery complex?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List modules, integrations, environments, migration volumes/data quality, customization, requirements maturity, technical debt, testing, security/compliance, client readiness, training and hypercare.

Q48. Separate subscription and services economics.

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Table fields

- Subscription / implementation / support / other
- Revenue (number)
- Attributable cost (number)
- Bundle / discount allocation
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q49. How do usage, customization and churn affect cost?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Give hosting/storage/API/AI/license usage, support effort, client-specific maintenance, term/renewal/expansion assumptions and setup costs unrecovered on cancellation.

Q50. How do your commercial components interact?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Explain shared staffing/cost allocation, minimum guarantees, offsets, caps and cross-subsidies. Which delivery obligations remain if variable fees fall? Do not double-count shared costs.

Delivery exposure

Approvals, rework, dependencies and automation.

Q51. What drives marketing or media workload?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Provide campaigns, channels, markets, creative assets, localization, optimization/reporting frequency, production obligations and media-funding requirements.

Q52. What drives consulting workload?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Provide partner/director hours, research and interview volumes, workshops, travel, specialist expertise and client decision dependencies.

Q53. How much coordination does this work require?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List approval groups, the final decision-maker, meeting/reporting hours per period, typical approval days and conflicting requirements.

Q54. How much rework should we expect?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Give included versus observed revisions, rework hours or share of effort, causes and recoverability. Separate measured history from estimates.

Q55. Which client dependencies could affect delivery?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

If none, enter “None” and use the review date.

Table fields

- Input / decision / dependency
- Responsible role / party
- Required date (date)
- Delay impact / likely extra cost

Q56. Does AI or automation affect this engagement?

Select one · Required · Unknown allowed

[ ] Yes — in use
[ ] Planned
[ ] No

Q57. What is the measured or expected AI impact?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Separate measured savings from assumed savings. Include adoption and exception-handling in your assumptions.

Table fields

- Task
- Comparable hours before (number)
- Hours after (number)
- Review / rework hours (number)
- Tool / API cost (number)
- Quality outcome / fee impact
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated

Q58. What contractual exposures could reduce margin?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

List service credits, penalties, refunds, warranty obligations, disputes and applicable limits. Enter “None” where appropriate.

Scenarios & actions

Define a credible downside and practical mitigation.

Q59. What changes at renewal or expansion?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Provide historic actual margin, demand/scope trends, proposed fees, extra staffing obligations and the change from the existing contract.

Q60. What are the recovery or exit economics?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Separate costs already incurred from incremental completion cost. State remaining recoverable revenue, exit obligations and recovery options.

Q61. What is your expected delivery case?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Confirm the revenue, workload, staffing and cost assumptions supporting the base case. Reference the figures provided earlier.

Q62. What credible downside should we test?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Quantify plausible changes. Identify changes that occur together; probabilities are optional and need evidence.

Table fields

- Revenue / hours / cost / delay / penalty
- Base assumption
- Downside assumption
- Unit / period
- Evidence and linked changes

Q63. What practical changes could protect the margin?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

If no mitigation is identified, say so and enter 0 for implementation cost.

Table fields

- Reprice / scope / staffing / governance / AI action
- Expected benefit + unit
- Implementation cost (number)
- Responsible role
- Timing
- Client approval / status

Q64. What strategic exception has been approved?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Give the subsidy or acceptable loss, approving role, time limit, expected benefit and review date. An exception is not evidence that an engagement is financially safe.

Evidence & review

Make uncertainty and missing information explicit.

Q65. How reliable are the material inputs?

Complete a table · Required · Unknown allowed

Reference documents rather than uploading them. Do not include passwords, credentials or employee salary records.

Table fields

- Material input / assumption
- Source document / system
- As-of date (date)
- Basis: actual / contracted / estimated
- Expected value and reasonable range

Q66. What information is still missing?

Written response · Required · Unknown allowed

Identify gaps that could materially change the result. Enter “None” if everything material is supported.

Q67. Who has reviewed this submission?

Select all that apply · Required

[ ] Account / client lead
[ ] Delivery lead
[ ] Finance
[ ] Commercial / leadership
[ ] Not yet reviewed